

A fancy provedore is a bit of an ask, but a restaurant or a flat-white joint that's a stroll or a car tootle away is a basic indulgence.

8. Parks and tree cover

Family-friendly playgrounds, walking tracks, picnic spots and nature reserves help to break up the urban sprawl.

9. Mobile coverage

To have to consider it in this day and age is ludicrous, but be sure that your provider's signal bars are nudging the maximum. You might think this is only applicable to the city's fringes, but when I lived in an inner-city suburb four kilometres from Melbourne's CBD, I could only get mobile reception in my bedroom. You can probably live without a neighbourhood café, but mobile black spots – that's surely a non-negotiable.

Source: An edited extract of 'Tract Consultants and Deloitte Access Economics Annual Capital City Liveability Reports' (*Domain*, 2017)